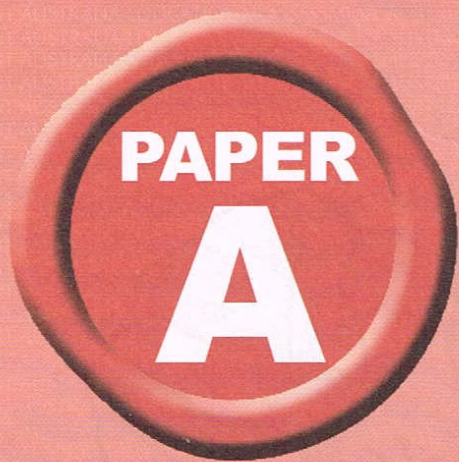




UNSW EDUCATIONAL ASSESSMENT
AUSTRALIA



ICAS

INTERNATIONAL COMPETITIONS AND ASSESSMENTS FOR SCHOOLS

ENGLISH

2009

DO NOT OPEN THIS BOOKLET UNTIL INSTRUCTED.

45 QUESTIONS

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

STUDENT'S NAME: *Husein*

Read the instructions on the **ANSWER SHEET** and fill in your **NAME, SCHOOL** and **OTHER INFORMATION**.

Use a 2B or B pencil.

Do **NOT** use a pen.

Rub out any mistakes completely.

You **MUST** record your answers on the **ANSWER SHEET**.

Mark only **ONE** answer for each question.

Your score will be the number of correct answers.

Marks are **NOT** deducted for incorrect answers.

There are **45 MULTIPLE-CHOICE QUESTIONS** (1–45).

Use the information provided to choose the **BEST** answer from the four possible options.

On your **ANSWER SHEET** fill in the oval that matches your answer.

Questions may sometimes be placed next to each other. Make sure you read **ACROSS** the page and answer the questions in the correct order.

You are **NOT** allowed to use a dictionary or an electronic translator.

**PLEASE SEE BACK COVER FOR A LIST
OF THE YEAR LEVELS THAT SHOULD
SIT THIS PAPER**

After the camping trip

After coming home from a three-day school camp, Peter dropped his bag on the floor and ran out to play.



1. What did Peter do when he returned home from the camping trip?
 - (A) He went out to play.
 - (B) He did his homework.
 - (C) He packed his school bag.
 - (D) He unpacked his dirty clothes.

2. What was Peter's favourite activity during the school camp?
 - (A) Pirate Island
 - (B) playing sport
 - (C) collecting bugs
 - (D) Science Project

3. What was Peter supposed to put into the plastic bag?
 - (A) his shirt
 - (B) his shoes
 - (C) uneaten food
 - (D) the tube of toothpaste

4. What mistake did Peter make in his Science Project?
 - (A) He did not feed the animals.
 - (B) He collected only two samples.
 - (C) He collected animals instead of plants.
 - (D) He did not write down what he had collected.

5. What do we know about Peter from the information given in the picture?
 - (A) He is untidy.
 - (B) He is afraid of bugs.
 - (C) He likes to eat all types of food.
 - (D) He enjoys playing with animals.

ARCHIMEDES AND THE GOLDEN CROWN



Archimedes was a great mathematician who lived more than 2000 years ago in the ancient Greek city of Syracuse. Many stories have been told about him. One of these is about a golden crown.

The king of Syracuse ordered a new crown to be made of pure gold. When the crown was delivered the king wanted to be sure

that it was, in fact, made from pure gold and that the goldsmiths had not tricked him by adding some silver. He asked Archimedes if he could prove whether the crown was made only of gold.

Archimedes knew that a piece of silver weighs less than a piece of gold of the same size but was not sure how he could find out whether the crown was made only of gold.

He found the answer one day as he stepped into his bath. He noticed that when he sat down, the water flowed over the edge. 'Eureka*! Eureka!' he shouted to his friend in the next room. 'Now I know what to do!' he told him.

6. Who asked Archimedes to prove that the crown was made of pure gold?
- (A) the king
 - (B) a friend
 - (C) the goldsmiths
 - (D) a mathematician
7. In the first paragraph, the sentence 'Many stories have been told about him' is
- (A) a question.
 - (B) a command.
 - (C) a statement.
 - (D) an exclamation.
8. Before Archimedes began his experiment he knew that
- (A) he would need the help of his friend.
 - (B) the crown was not made of pure gold.
 - (C) silver is not as heavy as a same-sized piece of gold.
 - (D) he would have to get into the bath wearing the crown.



The next day Archimedes planned an experiment. He completely filled a bowl with water and placed a piece of gold, which weighed the same as the crown, into the bowl. He then measured how much water flowed over the top. Next, he refilled the bowl and placed the crown into the water. Again he measured how much water flowed over the top. This time more water flowed out proving that the crown was not pure gold.

How did he know? Adding silver to the crown increased its volume so more water was displaced (flowed over).

** means 'I've found it.'*



9. The illustrations on this page have been included to
 - (A) show how much the crown weighed.
 - (B) provide a picture of the king and his crown.
 - (C) show how Archimedes did his experiment.
 - (D) provide some more information about the crown.
10. How did Archimedes check the volume of the crown?
 - (A) He used a set of scales to weigh the crown.
 - (B) He measured how much water was displaced.
 - (C) He measured the level of the water in the bowl.
 - (D) He compared the size of the crown to a piece of gold.
11. The purpose of the asterisk * is to tell the reader that
 - (A) 'Eureka!' is repeated.
 - (B) 'Eureka!' is a foreign word.
 - (C) the meaning of the word is unclear.
 - (D) an explanation of the word will be given.

Read *The brown horse* and answer questions 12 to 18.

The brown horse

Today my family and I drove out to Millthorpe to see Granny and Grandpa. It took us three hours from Sydney. Millthorpe is near Orange in country New South Wales. For the entire trip I thought about only two things. The first thing was how to beat my older sister Carla in a game of 'eye spy' and the second was the huge horse near my grandparents' house. I had first seen the horse when we were last at my grandparents' home.

When we finally arrived Carla and I walked with anticipation towards the paddock where I had last seen the amazing animal. In the paddock the grass looked more like straw and the only scraps of green came from the gum trees. When we got there we stopped at the fence. All of a sudden my ears were filled with the sound of loud drumming. I could feel vibrations through the hard ground. I turned my head to see the rusty brown horse surging straight towards me. It thundered downhill across the paddock, painting a brown smear across the landscape.

The horse stopped abruptly when it came to the fence that was separating me from it. It gazed down at me with an arrogant stare. Its velvety brown



body was heaving. Steam rose from the great animal like a white mist. Its nostrils flared wide as it whinnied loudly. I bravely put my hand out to allow the horse to smell it. It sniffed and nuzzled my hand. Its long nose felt firm under my hand and its earthy fur felt sleek and soft. The smell of hay and horse filled my nostrils.

In an instant the animal snatched its head away from my hand. It then turned its large barrel body away and thundered back across the parched paddock, satisfied. I stood staring after the horse until it became a dash of brown in the environment.

12. The narrator had first seen the horse
- (A) on the way to Millthorpe.
 - (B) when it came up to the fence.
 - (C) as it thundered across a paddock.
 - (D) the last time she visited her grandparents.
13. The 'sound of loud drumming' came from
- (A) thunder on the hillside.
 - (B) Carla jumping up and down.
 - (C) the noise of the children running.
 - (D) the noise made by the horse's hooves.
14. The words 'painting a brown smear across the landscape' mean that the horse
- (A) was covered with dirt.
 - (B) ran so fast it was like a blur.
 - (C) blended well into the paddock.
 - (D) was running on a muddy track.
15. Which word suggests that the writer was a little nervous about the horse?
- (A) 'heaving'
 - (B) 'flared'
 - (C) 'bravely'
 - (D) 'snatched'
16. What does the word 'parched' mean?
- (A) flat (B) brown (C) large (D) dry
17. The main purpose of this text is to
- (A) describe a horse.
 - (B) tell a story about two sisters.
 - (C) recount a holiday to Millthorpe.
 - (D) narrate the events of a family outing.
18. What is the best way to combine the first three sentences of the text without changing their meaning?
- (A) Today my family and I drove three hours from Sydney to Millthorpe to see Granny and Grandpa, which is near Orange in country New South Wales.
 - (B) Today my family and I drove out to Millthorpe, which is near Orange in country New South Wales and three hours from Sydney, to see Granny and Grandpa.
 - (C) Today my family and I drove out to Millthorpe to see Granny and Grandpa which took us three hours from Sydney, near Orange in country New South Wales.
 - (D) Today my family and I drove out to Millthorpe, near Orange in country New South Wales, to see Granny and Grandpa which took us three hours from Sydney.

For questions 19 to 21 choose the correct word to complete the paragraph.

The Pool

It is a small beach. At one end is a natural rock pool where young children can paddle and splash. Next to that is a larger pool that _____ (19) _____ built along the ocean edge. At high tide waves break over the side of the pool and wash _____ (20) _____ clean. Behind the beach is a large grassy area _____ (21) _____ families can picnic and enjoy summer days.

19. (A) would be
(B) could be
(C) has been
(D) was being

20. (A) it
(B) this
(C) them
(D) these

21. (A) that
(B) here
(C) when
(D) where



For questions 22 to 25 choose the option CLOSEST IN MEANING to the underlined word.

Who invented sliced bread?

The idea that bread should be bought already sliced and wrapped was the (22) brainchild not of a baker but of a jeweller. His name was Otto Rohwedder. In 1912, he realised that if his bread-slicing machine was to be successful, he would need to keep the bread fresh. One of his first efforts used hairpins but, as expected, the idea was not received with great (23) enthusiasm!

Despite many setbacks, he was (24) convinced that his idea would completely change the baking business. He finally succeeded in 1928 when bread was sliced and wrapped (25) commercially at Chillicothe Baking Company for the first time.

22. (A) first thought
(B) original idea
(C) creative plan
(D) favourite wish

23. (A) praise
(B) reward
(C) interest
(D) surprise

24. (A) aware
(B) certain
(C) pleased
(D) satisfied

25. (A) to be sold
(B) by machine
(C) in one action
(D) after many times



BEHIND THE SCENES AT THE ZOO

Take a peek behind the scenes at Adelaide Zoo and you'll find there's much more to zoos than meets the public eye.



Imagine doing the grocery shopping for 1300 hungry animals whose favourite foods include mushed-up termites, mice, hay, bananas, raw meat and bamboo. Your list would be pretty long! It's the food storeperson's job to buy all this food each day and divide it up for the keepers to prepare.



Like humans, animals occasionally get sick or hurt themselves—even in a protected environment such as a zoo—but no job is too large or small for the zoo's veterinarians. They do everything from serious operations to cleaning cuts and trimming toenails. Just like humans, animals such as this gorilla aren't fond of visiting the doctor and need a bit of comforting.



Ahhhh, there's nothing like a good hose-down! While hippos are normally aquatic creatures (they spend most of their time in water), a spray with a hose is still a welcome treat. Whether it's a hose-down, a backrub or a favourite snack, zoo-keepers like to spoil their animals occasionally to keep them happy and healthy.



A baby bird takes its first look at the world from inside a special egg incubator that keeps eggs warm until they hatch. Zoos play an important role in breeding native and endangered animals and putting them back in the wild. Breeding programs such as these may help save some animals from extinction.

26. As it is used in this text, the phrase 'behind the scenes' indicates that the information about the zoo
- (A) may not be available all the time.
 - (B) is secret and therefore hard to find.
 - (C) is something only a few people know.
 - (D) may not be known by all zoo-keepers.
27. Why does the writer list some of the food that the zoo animals eat?
- (A) to show that zoo animals have a choice of food
 - (B) to emphasise that zoo animals are meat eaters
 - (C) to highlight that the food storeperson's job is difficult
 - (D) to prove that the food storeperson is the animals' favourite person
28. In the text the zoo is described as a 'protected environment' because
- (A) there are no predators to attack the animals.
 - (B) visitors are only allowed in the zoo during the day.
 - (C) the enclosures look like the animals' natural habitats.
 - (D) the animals are kept in cages to keep them away from visitors.
29. The words 'they spend most of their time in water' are placed in brackets () because
- (A) the writer added them to the text later.
 - (B) the information they provide is unimportant.
 - (C) they give additional information about hippos.
 - (D) they explain the meaning of 'aquatic creatures'.
30. According to the text, what is an incubator used for?
- (A) It keeps native and endangered animals apart.
 - (B) It helps eggs to hatch if there are no adult birds.
 - (C) It provides a warm environment for sick animals.
 - (D) It allows chicks to grow before they go back to the wild.
31. 'Breeding programs such as these may help save some animals from extinction.'
- In the sentence the word 'programs' is
- (A) a verb.
 - (B) a noun.
 - (C) an adjective.
 - (D) a conjunction.
32. Arrows have been included in this text in order to
- (A) remind readers what they should read first.
 - (B) point out the most important feature in each picture.
 - (C) show clearly the picture that matches the information.
 - (D) tell readers that pictures are more important than words.

BREATHING UNDERWATER

Water was extremely important to Adam Windsong as he grew older because of his ability to breathe in it. This was something he kept secret. That traumatic time when he had been surprised while perfecting his technique in the bath after his dunking in the lake had caused torrents of tears from his mother, an almighty row between her and his father, and the sudden arrival of an ambulance officer who had thumped his chest, pinched his nose, and breathed into his mouth with his own, which smelled of cigarettes and pizza. He remembered all this. Had he not been too young to talk he would have told them all that he was perfectly okay. Just practising. But it was enough to make him realise that underwater breathing was an art that was neither common nor easily understood.

Because of the secrecy involved it was not even an especially useful art. He chose not to make his ability widely known, and had, with just one or two exceptions, resisted the temptation to show off. While a fifth-grade student at Cardigan Bay Primary School he did win the under-11 fifty-metre breaststroke event at the annual swimming carnival by diving in and not resurfacing until he reached the other end, but he was subsequently disqualified when the sports master, Ivan Galbraith, ruled that breaststroke was not an underwater event. This was despite the fact that all the judges had declared Adam's swimming style and kick, at least what they could see of it from the surface, to be impeccable.

33. Why did the ambulance officer thump Adam's chest and pinch his nose?
- (A) He believed that Adam had drowned.
 - (B) He wanted to help Adam to correct his technique.
 - (C) He was punishing Adam for making his mother cry.
 - (D) He was teaching Adam's parents what to do in future.
34. Approximately how old was Adam when he realised he could breathe underwater?
- (A) ten years old
 - (B) five years old
 - (C) older than 11 years old
 - (D) younger than two years old
35. Why did Adam keep his ability to breathe underwater a secret?
- (A) It got him into trouble with his parents.
 - (B) He realised that this skill was unusual.
 - (C) It was a skill that was not particularly useful.
 - (D) He did not want the ambulance officer to be called again.
36. What happened to Adam at the swimming carnival?
- (A) He had first place taken away from him.
 - (B) The sports master praised his swimming technique.
 - (C) He used the wrong swimming style and lost the race.
 - (D) The school cheered when he swam the whole length underwater.
37. Choose the word that correctly completes the sentence.
- The words 'at least what they could see of it from the surface' are meant to be read in a _____ tone of voice.
- (A) cheerful
 - (B) frustrated
 - (C) humorous
 - (D) disappointed
38. The word 'impeccable' means
- (A) stylish.
 - (B) perfect.
 - (C) creative.
 - (D) beautiful.

FINDING A THYLACINE

To palaeontologists, Riversleigh in north-west Queensland is an absolute treasure-trove. Fossils of hundreds of extinct mammals, reptiles and birds have been found there.

Around 25–30 million years ago, Riversleigh was covered by low-lying rainforests and spring-fed pools and lakes saturated with dissolved limestone. As the climate became drier, a crust formed over some pools and lakes. Many animals fell through the crust and drowned. The pools and lakes became graveyards when the limy mud encasing the animals hardened and turned to stone.

In late 1996 when scientists were working on an ancient cave site in Riversleigh, they used a sledgehammer on a metre-thick boulder. A corner broke off and another 'gem' was revealed in the limestone: a 17-million-year-old skull.

At first, the scientists weren't certain which animal it belonged to. Work began in 1997 to free the skull from its rocky grave. The limestone block was lowered by cranes into a large vat containing weak acetic acid, which dissolves limestone without damaging the fossils. More of the skull became exposed. Part of the jaw and some teeth were now clearly visible. Scientists can use teeth to identify an animal, so they could now tell that the remains belonged to a thylacine (a prehistoric ancestor of the extinct Tasmanian tiger).

Over the following months more bones began to see the light of day for the first time in millions of years: the other jaw, vertebrae, part of the hip, ribs and front limb bones. The acid solution was changed every 10–14 days and the block was lifted out, placed in clean water for a day, then dried for a day. Exposed fossils were treated with liquid plastic which hardens, protects and preserves them.

Up until this time, only a few thylacine jaw fragments had ever been found at Riversleigh. By January 1998, an almost complete skeleton was recovered.



The thylacine skeleton was from a species that was about half the size of the Tasmanian tiger. It was named Dickson's Thylacine (*Nimbacinus dicksoni*).

A scientific illustration of the 17-million-year-old thylacine skull



39. Why was Riversleigh considered a 'treasure-trove' by palaeontologists?
- (A) It had bones of both ancient and modern animals.
 - (B) It was the only place where thylacine fossils were found.
 - (C) It was a beautiful natural environment with lakes and pools.
 - (D) It contained remains of many different types of extinct animals.
40. A metaphor describes one thing by comparing it to something else in order to suggest a similarity.
- Which of the following is an example of a metaphor?
- (A) 'pools and lakes saturated with dissolved limestone'
 - (B) 'a crust formed over some pools and lakes'
 - (C) 'animals fell through the crust'
 - (D) 'The pools and lakes became graveyards'
41. Which words tell the reader that the limestone block was very hard?
- (A) 'used a sledgehammer'
 - (B) 'lowered by cranes'
 - (C) 'into a large vat'
 - (D) 'The acid solution was changed'
42. At what point in their investigation did the scientists first discover that the fossil in the limestone block came from a thylacine?
- (A) when they broke open the boulder
 - (B) after they had reassembled the whole skeleton
 - (C) as they took the limestone block to the laboratory
 - (D) when they examined the teeth that they had uncovered
43. The fossils were treated with liquid plastic in order to
- (A) help the limestone dissolve faster.
 - (B) protect the bones after they had been uncovered.
 - (C) prevent the acetic acid from damaging the bones.
 - (D) help join the bones together to form a whole skeleton.
44. What was unique about the discovery of this thylacine skeleton?
- (A) It was the first thylacine found in the Riversleigh region.
 - (B) It was the only evidence of a thylacine fossil in Riversleigh.
 - (C) It was the first skeleton to prove the existence of thylacines in Riversleigh.
 - (D) It was the most complete thylacine skeleton to be discovered in Riversleigh.
45. Which word best describes the scientists' attitude towards their work?
- (A) anxious
 - (B) cautious
 - (C) fearless
 - (D) confused



ACKNOWLEDGMENT

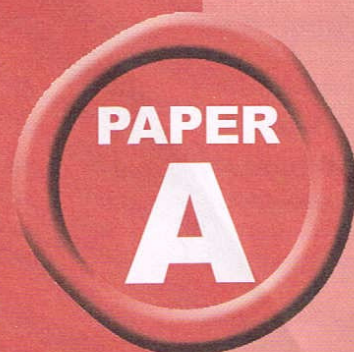
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SOURCES

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- Page 10** "Behind the scenes at the zoo" text from 'Behind the scenes at the Zoo', *Scientrific* No. 4, November/December 2006, www.csiro.au/scientrific. Image of vet and gorilla courtesy of Adelaide Zoo. Images of foodstore, hippopotamus, incubator courtesy of David Mattner.
- Page 12** "Breathing underwater" text from the novel *Breathing Underwater* (1997) by Alan Attwood.
- Pages 14–15** "Finding a thylacine" text from 'Finding a thylacine' by Kathryn England, *The School Magazine: Touchdown* June 2007, published by the NSW Department of Education and Training. Scientific illustrations by Anne Musser.

**THE FOLLOWING YEAR LEVELS
SHOULD SIT THIS PAPER:**

AUSTRALIA: Year 3
BRUNEI: Primary 3
INDONESIA: Year 4
MALAYSIA: Standard 3
NEW ZEALAND: Year 4
PACIFIC: Year 3
SINGAPORE: Primary 2
SOUTH AFRICA: Grade 3




E
2009 English Answer Keys
ICAS
 International Competitions
 and Assessments for Schools

Question Number	Paper A	Paper B	Paper C	Paper D	Paper E	Paper F	Papers G & H	Papers I & J
1	A	B	D	B	A	A	A	C
2	A	B	A	D	C	C	C	A
3	B	A	A	C	B	D	B	D
4	C	A	A	B	B	B	A	B
5	A	B	C	C	D	A	D	B
6	A	C	B	A	D	D	D	A
7	C	B	D	B	A	C	A	B
8	C	B	D	A	D	B	C	D
9	C	D	C	A	D	D	A	A
10	B	D	B	A	A	C	A	B
11	D	D	A	B	A	B	C	D
12	D	A	A	C	C	C	C	C
13	D	C	C	C	B	A	A	D
14	B	A	B	D	A	B	B	D
15	C	D	D	D	A	D	D	D
16	D	A	D	A	B	D	D	A
17	A	C	C	C	D	C	B	A
18	B	B	B	D	A	B	B	C
19	C	B	C	C	A	A	B	A
20	A	D	A	D	B	B	D	B
21	D	A	B	B	C	A	C	C
22	B	D	A	C	B	C	B	C
23	C	B	A	B	A	C	D	B
24	B	A	B	D	D	C	B	D
25	A	C	B	C	D	D	A	A
26	C	B	D	B	C	D	C	C
27	C	B	A	A	B	B	C	A
28	A	B	C	C	A	A	D	B
29	D	C	D	B	C	D	A	A
30	B	C	A	C	B	C	B	D
31	B	D	D	A	C	C	D	C
32	C	C	C	D	C	B	C	D
33	A	D	B	B	B	D	D	A
34	D	A	C	D	D	B	A	B
35	B	D	C	D	C	A	A	C
36	A	C	D	A	B	C	B	D
37	C	B	C	B	C	A	C	A
38	B	C	D	A	A	B	D	C
39	D	A	B	C	B	C	A	B
40	D	D	C	D	B	D	C	B

(Please turn over)



E

2009 English Answer Keys

ICAS

International Competitions
and Assessments for Schools

Question Number	Paper A	Paper B	Paper C	Paper D	Paper E	Paper F	Papers G & H	Papers I & J
41	A	D	B	A	C	D	B	B
42	D	D	A	B	D	A	D	D
43	B	C	C	B	D	B	D	A
44	D	A	A	C	C	A	C	B
45	B	C	C	D	C	B	A	A
46			B	B	A	C	C	C
47			D	A	A	A	B	D
48			B	A	B	D	C	A
49			B	A	C	B	A	C
50			C	D	D	A	B	C
51					D	B	A	C
52					D	D	B	A
53					C	A	C	D
54					A	D	A	C
55					B	C	B	D
56							D	D
57							C	B
58							B	D
59							D	C
60							D	A

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